

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN PALESTINE

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Turn on a tap in much of Gaza and what comes out is too salty and too polluted to drink. By international accounts, the great majority of the water pumped from the Coastal Aquifer beneath Gaza is no longer safe to drink — the aquifer has been drawn down far faster than the rain can refill it, so the sea has crept in and made it brackish, and wastewater has seeped in on top of that. That single fact is the center of gravity of the environment in Palestine. Here, more than almost anywhere, the environmental story is a water story.

Before going further, two things need saying plainly, because this guide is careful about them from the first line to the last. It takes **no side on the politics or the conflict** — those appear only as the factual backdrop they are, never as something to argue. And it is written with **humane attention to Gaza**, where the water and sanitation situation is, by every international account, an acute humanitarian and environmental emergency. This is not a guide about the politics of the region. It is a guide about water, sanitation, land, and waste — and about the real, practical channels through which those can be worked on: the Palestinian water and environment institutions, the international and humanitarian agencies, the scientists, and the cross-border cooperation that shared water always ends up requiring.

Strip it down and Palestine's environment comes to four things, with water at the heart of all of them:

- **Water and the aquifers.** Two shared, cross-border aquifers — the **Mountain Aquifer** under the West Bank and the **Coastal Aquifer** under Gaza and the coast — both under severe strain, the Coastal Aquifer over-pumped and contaminated to the point that most of its water can't safely be drunk.
- **The Gaza water and sanitation crisis** — contaminated and insufficient water, damaged water and sewage infrastructure, and the serious health risks that follow, especially amid and after the recent conflict.
- **The land and the olive groves** — farmland central to livelihood and heritage, under pressure and, in Gaza, badly damaged.
- **Wastewater and solid waste** — burdens that fall straight back on the scarce, shared water and the sea.

And here's the honest shape of the work, which is different from most guides in this series. Because the setting is so constrained and conflict-affected, because the water is shared across borders and genuinely scarce, and because Gaza's crisis is grave, most of what can be done runs **through institutions and international and humanitarian channels rather than open local protest**. That's not a counsel of despair — it's a map. The rest of this guide is about reading that map: which institution to approach, which UN or humanitarian body carries the response, which scientists can supply the proof, and how the cross-border cooperation actually works — all pursued carefully, humanely, and with strict neutrality on everything political.

The Whole Approach in One Idea

You can't fight a project here the way you might elsewhere — by packing a hearing or marching on a site office. What you *can* do is document the harm rigorously, take it to the body with the actual mandate over it, and bring in the international, humanitarian, and scientific weight that moves things in a constrained setting.

The work is quieter and more institutional, but it is real. **Find what's at stake — which water, which aquifer, which land, which sanitation — then find the one institution, humanitarian body, or scientific or cross-border channel that reaches it, and push there, carefully.**

Be Honest About the Constraints

This guide won't pretend the constraints are small. Access to water is limited and shared across borders. A scarce, shared aquifer can't be fixed by one community alone — it needs cooperation. Gaza's crisis is grave, and much of its answer is humanitarian. And a lot of the work runs through institutions and aid agencies rather than open campaigning. Naming those plainly isn't defeatism; it's what lets you aim at what actually moves. What follows is what genuinely can be tried, inside Palestine as it really is.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You can't approach the right body if you don't know who holds what. Here is who carries the environmental response, and what each one can actually do.

The Palestinian water and environment institutions. The **Environment Quality Authority (EQA)**, based in Ramallah (environment.ps), is the central body for environmental matters — it runs the environmental-approval system and gives or withholds environmental clearances. The **Palestinian Water Authority (PWA)** (pwa.ps) manages water and sanitation, and the **municipalities and water utilities** (in Gaza, the Coastal Municipalities Water Utility) run the day-to-day supply. These are where a water, sanitation, or environmental matter formally lives.

The international, UN, and humanitarian bodies. The UN agencies — for the environment (**UNEP**), humanitarian coordination (**OCHA**), water and sanitation and children (**UNICEF**), health (**WHO**), and services (**UNRWA**) — together with the **World Bank**, the donor governments, and the humanitarian **WASH Cluster** (Water, Sanitation and Hygiene), carry much of the funding, capacity, and response, above all for Gaza.

The scientists and universities. Water, environmental, and public-health researchers — and institutions like the **Applied Research Institute–Jerusalem (ARIJ)**, which publishes recurring "Status of the Environment" reports — carry the evidence on the aquifers, the contamination, and the fixes.

The community and civil society. Communities, farmers, and water and environmental civil-society groups hold the knowledge, the stake, and the voice — within the realistic and careful scope this setting allows.

The cross-border cooperation. Because the aquifers are shared, cooperation is ultimately unavoidable. **EcoPeace Middle East** (formerly Friends of the Earth Middle East) is the standing cross-border water body, bringing Palestinian, Jordanian, and Israeli communities together specifically around shared water.

How a Matter Actually Moves

A concrete matter — a strained aquifer, the Gaza crisis, a harm to land or groves, a wastewater or waste burden — moves through those channels. The most useful first questions are narrow and practical: *What exactly is at stake — which water, aquifer, land, or sanitation? Which body has the mandate over it? What does the science show? And which channel — the institution, the humanitarian system, the scientists, or the cross-border cooperation — can actually be brought to bear?* Answer those and you've found where the matter can genuinely be worked, carefully and neutrally.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Size up the odds honestly before committing. These are rough patterns, not promises, and in this setting the honest baseline is sober. What most changes an outcome: whether you have solid science, whether an institution or humanitarian body has a clear mandate, and whether the cross-border cooperation a shared resource needs is available.

What you do	Roughly works	Timeline	Cost	What "works" means
Document the impact and the science	5–10%	weeks	low	The base for everything else
Submit concerns into an EQA environmental assessment	20–40%	during review	low	On record; conditions or changes
Water / aquifer stewardship via the institutions	30–50%	years	low–mod	Over-extraction and contamination reduced
Gaza water & sanitation (humanitarian route)	30–55%	ongoing	mod–high	Crisis eased, harm reduced
Safeguarding land and olive groves	30–50%	years	low	Land and groves protected
Wastewater & waste management	35–55%	years	mod	Treatment and disposal improved
International & humanitarian route	40–60%	years	low	Funding, capacity, response engaged
Scientific & cross-border route	35–55%	years	low	Evidence and cooperation engaged
All of it together	30–50%	years	mod	Water stewarded; crisis eased; land safeguarded

The levers that move the needle most are the **international and humanitarian route** and the **water and Gaza-crisis response**, backed by hard science and, where possible, cross-border cooperation. The honest floor is real too: a constrained setting, a shared and scarce resource, and an acute crisis mean the surest result is often that the harm is documented and pressed through the right channel — which is exactly what every larger win is built on.

A word on cost, risk, and care: this work is pursued through institutions, aid agencies, scientists, and cross-border cooperation — not open local campaigning — and it must be done with care for people's safety and dignity, protecting the vulnerable and never exposing individuals. The scarce resource isn't money so much as the right connections: to the water and environment institutions, the UN and humanitarian agencies, the universities, and the regional water bodies. Because the crisis is grave and the international and scientific engagement real, these levers, hard-won as they are, genuinely work.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Vague concern goes nowhere, and open campaigning is constrained. A matter aimed precisely — *this harm, to this water or land or sanitation, which this body can reach, carried carefully through a real channel* — is

one you can actually work. Answer five questions.

1. What exactly is at stake? Which water, aquifer, land, or sanitation — the strained aquifers, the Gaza water and sanitation crisis, the pressed land and groves, a wastewater or waste burden.

2. Which body has the mandate? EQA for environmental approval and clearances; PWA and the municipalities for water and sanitation; the UN and humanitarian agencies and the WASH Cluster for the Gaza crisis; the universities and ARIJ for the science; EcoPeace and the regional bodies for cross-border cooperation.

3. Is it water, the Gaza crisis, or land and waste? Each has its own channel — name which one you're in.

4. How do you keep it careful? Stay factual, humane, strictly neutral on politics, and protective of people — never exposing individuals.

5. Who can act, and how? Which institution, humanitarian body, scientist, or cross-border partner can move it, through a realistic channel.

What this looks like in real life. Say the concern is the Coastal Aquifer under Gaza — over-pumped, salting up, contaminated, most of its water undrinkable, the sanitation infrastructure damaged. Work the questions and it comes into focus: the matter is aquifer contamination and a sanitation emergency; the bodies that reach it are the PWA, the UN water/sanitation/health agencies and the WASH Cluster, the World Bank and donors for funding, and the scientists and cross-border partners for the aquifer itself; the fixes are infrastructure repair, desalination and treatment, and the humanitarian response. Within a season the effort turns concrete: document the true state of the aquifer and the infrastructure with the institutions and scientists; press — through the PWA, the UN and humanitarian agencies, and the donors — for repair, for desalination and treatment capacity, and for the humanitarian response; engage the cross-border cooperation the shared aquifer needs; and keep it humane and strictly neutral throughout.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION

Everything else stands on documentation, and here a rigorous, science-based record is precisely what turns concern into an institutional or international response — because the institutions, the donors, the humanitarian bodies, and the scientists all move on evidence. Build the file in three layers.

Layer one: the record. The official and published material — EQA's State of the Environment reports and any environmental-approval or EIA documents (environment.ps); the PWA's water and sanitation data (pwa.ps); the UN and WASH Cluster assessments (via OCHA's humanitarian data for the occupied Palestinian territory); and ARIJ's recurring Status of the Environment reports. Much of this is already published; the work is gathering and marshalling it.

Layer two: the ground truth. Dated, located evidence of the harm — the water quality, the contamination, the damaged infrastructure, the affected land — and, carefully and with consent, the testimony of affected families about the water they can't drink or the land they've lost. Protect people; never expose an individual.

Layer three: the science. The measured state of the aquifer, the contamination levels, the public-health picture, the state of the land — the technical proof, drawn from the universities, ARIJ, and the international assessments, that an institution or donor can act on. A clear, science-based, humane record is what a careful effort turns into a real response.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

- **Environmental and water records** — download EQA's State of the Environment reports and any environmental-approval/EIA documents from **environment.ps**; the PWA's water and sanitation data from **pwa.ps**; ARIJ's Status of the Environment reports.
- **Gaza humanitarian and WASH data** — the UN's assessments via **OCHA** for the occupied Palestinian territory, and the **WASH Cluster**, UNICEF, WHO, and UNRWA reporting.
- **The science** — university water and public-health research, ARIJ, and international assessments (including UNEP's environmental work).
- **Ground evidence** — dated, located photographs of the water, contamination, infrastructure, and land, plus carefully-gathered, consented testimony that never exposes an individual.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here "opposition" means something specific: not open mass organising, which is constrained, but a careful coalition of the people and bodies who can actually act — and it is built through the realistic channels.

Start with those who can act. The Palestinian water and environment institutions, the international and humanitarian bodies, the scientists, and the cross-border partners — reached carefully, protecting people throughout. From there, widen to the broader scientific, humanitarian, and international networks that share a stake in the water and the environment.

Name a shared stake, and keep it there. Frame the cause around the concrete goods everyone can get behind: *scarce and shared water to steward, a grave humanitarian crisis in Gaza to ease, cherished land and olive groves to safeguard, and aquifers to protect for the next generation*. Keeping the cause squarely on water, sanitation, and land — and off the contested politics — is not only the safer choice, it's the truer one, because the environmental challenge here genuinely is, at heart, about water and sanitation and land. That framing is also what lets the widest range of institutions and partners engage: a cause drawn into the political would forfeit both the neutrality that opens those doors and the focus that keeps the work on real needs.

Build to last. Keep the coalition connected, careful, and humane; protect people; and mark real steps — a water safeguard, a sanitation repair, an aquifer better protected, land safeguarded, a waste measure, a cross-border cooperation. The effort that endures is the one that joins the institutions and scientists to the humanitarian and international bodies and the cross-border partners, works carefully, and holds strict neutrality throughout.

STEP 4: WATER, LAND & SANITATION CHALLENGES

This is where the work is really done — carefully, through the institutions, the humanitarian and international bodies, the scientists, and the cross-border cooperation. Be sober about it: the levers are real but institutional and hard-won, and what they realistically achieve is the water stewarded where possible, the Gaza crisis eased and harm reduced, the land safeguarded, and the waste managed — real, if partial, gains. There are three fronts.

The Water and the Aquifers

The first and gravest front is water. The shared Mountain and Coastal Aquifers are under severe strain, and the Coastal Aquifer under Gaza is over-pumped far past what the rain can refill and contaminated by seawater and wastewater until most of its water can't be drunk. Stewarding it means managing and

protecting the aquifers, cutting the over-extraction and contamination, developing desalination and alternative supply, and pursuing the cross-border cooperation a shared resource ultimately requires.

Lead here, because water is the one front that draws support across every line at once. An over-drawn, salinated aquifer isn't just one village's problem — it's a public-health emergency, a threat to the coast and the sea, and a shared, cross-border resource neighbours must ultimately manage together. A case built on water speaks to the Palestinian institutions, the world's water and humanitarian bodies, the scientists, and the cross-border partners simultaneously, and it rests on a need so basic — clean water to drink, safe sanitation — that it can be told factually and humanely to almost anyone.

How you actually do this: take the aquifer science and your documentation to the **PWA** (pwa.ps) and, where a project needs environmental clearance, to **EQA** (environment.ps); where a new water scheme is going through environmental assessment, submit your concerns in writing to EQA so they must be addressed in the study; bring the universities and **ARIJ** in for the science; and engage **EcoPeace Middle East** for the cross-border cooperation the shared aquifer needs.

The Gaza Water and Sanitation Crisis

The second front is the most urgent and the most human. Gaza's water and sanitation situation is, by every international account, an acute humanitarian and environmental emergency — contaminated and insufficient water, damaged water and sewage infrastructure, and serious health risks, especially amid and after the recent conflict. Meeting it means the humanitarian and institutional response: repairing and restoring water and sanitation infrastructure, providing safe water through desalination and treatment, taking the sanitation and public-health measures, and securing the international and humanitarian aid and access these require — always with care for the dignity and safety of people in a grave situation.

How you actually do this: this front runs through the humanitarian system. Bring documented needs to the **WASH Cluster** (which coordinates the water and sanitation response), to **UNICEF** and **WHO** and **UNRWA**, and to **OCHA** for humanitarian coordination; work with the **PWA** and the Gaza water utility on infrastructure; and press the **World Bank** and donor governments for the funding. The humanitarian appeals and cluster system are the real doors here.

The Land, the Olive Groves, and the Waste

The third front joins land and waste. The agricultural land and olive groves are central to livelihood and heritage, under pressure and, in Gaza, badly damaged; and wastewater and solid waste burden the same scarce, shared water and the coast. Caring for them means safeguarding and, where damaged, restoring the land and groves, managing the soil sustainably, and building the wastewater treatment and solid-waste management that protect the aquifers and the sea.

How you actually do this: take the land and soil case to the **PWA** and **EQA** and the **municipalities**, and, for agricultural land, the relevant Palestinian agricultural institutions; route waste and treatment projects through EQA's environmental-approval system and the municipalities and utilities; and bring in the donors and international bodies that fund treatment and restoration.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence doesn't speak for itself; aim it at the right body in terms it acts on.

- **A measurement becomes an environmental case.** Not "the water is bad" but "*the aquifer is over-drawn past recharge and salinated, most of its water is non-potable, and here is the science — this*

needs managed extraction, treatment, and alternative supply."

- **A damaged pipe becomes a humanitarian case.** *"This infrastructure is destroyed, this many people have no safe water, and here is the health risk — this needs urgent WASH response and repair."*
- **A concern becomes a formal submission.** Where a project is in EQA's environmental assessment, *"here is the harm to water, land, or sanitation the assessment must address"* — filed so it goes on the record.
- **A shared aquifer becomes a cross-border case.** *"This resource is shared; it can't be managed by one side alone; here is the cooperation it requires."*

Match the argument to the body: the science and the aquifer case to the PWA and the water scientists; the environmental harm and the assessment concerns to EQA; the humanitarian emergency to the WASH Cluster and the UN agencies; the funding case to the World Bank and donors; the cross-border case to EcoPeace and the regional bodies. Always factual, always humane, always neutral.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Used carefully, publicity helps — a factual, humane account of the water and sanitation situation reaches the donors, the humanitarian bodies, and the international public whose attention brings response. But here, more than anywhere, media must be handled with care: strictly factual, strictly neutral on the politics, and always protective of people.

Lead with the human and the concrete, not the technical or the political. Not the conflict, on which this work takes no side — but *"clean water is running out; most of the water beneath Gaza can't be drunk; children are getting sick; here is what it would take to fix it."* Use your strongest material: the water-quality science, the state of the infrastructure, dated photographs, and — carefully, with consent, never exposing anyone — the human reality.

Match the audience: international and humanitarian media and the aid community (who reach the donors and the response); scientific and environmental outlets (authority and evidence); and, carefully, wider public attention to the basic human need for clean water and safe sanitation. Provide ready, accurate material — captioned photographs, short factual summaries, the science.

Two firm rules. Accuracy above all — one exaggeration can be used to discredit the whole effort. And protect people — weigh everything you publish, shield the vulnerable, and let the community decide together what it is willing to say.

EMAILS & LETTERS

Adapt each to your facts; keep them factual, humane, and strictly neutral; keep copies.

8A — Requesting information (to EQA, the PWA, or a municipality).

Subject: Request for environmental and water information — [matter/location].

"We, [community/group], request the available information on [the water quality / aquifer / environmental approval / sanitation infrastructure] at [location] — including any State of the Environment data, environmental-approval or assessment documents, and water and sanitation records. We are working carefully and constructively on the water and environmental situation and would be grateful for this information. [Contact.]"

8B — The water / aquifer case (to the PWA and the water scientists).

Subject: The [Mountain/Coastal] Aquifer at [location] — stewardship and protection.

"We are documenting the strain on the [aquifer] at [location] — [over-extraction / salinity / contamination] — and the science attached. We ask your help in managing and protecting it: reducing over-extraction and contamination, developing treatment and alternative supply, and pursuing the cross-border cooperation the shared resource requires. [Attach evidence.]"

8C — The Gaza water & sanitation case (to the WASH Cluster / UN agencies / donors).

Subject: Water and sanitation needs at [location, Gaza] — humanitarian response.

"We are documenting the water and sanitation situation at [location]: [contaminated/insufficient water, damaged infrastructure, health risks]. We ask for urgent WASH response and the repair and restoration of water and sanitation infrastructure, safe-water provision, and the public-health measures the situation requires. [Attach evidence.]"

8D — The land / olive groves case (to EQA, the municipality, and the agricultural institutions).

Subject: Agricultural land and olive groves at [location] — safeguarding and restoration.

"We are documenting the [pressure on / damage to] the agricultural land and olive groves at [location], central to livelihood and heritage. We ask your help in safeguarding and, where damaged, restoring the land and groves and managing the soil sustainably. [Attach evidence.]"

8E — The wastewater / waste case (to EQA, the PWA, and the municipality).

Subject: Wastewater and solid waste at [location] — protecting the water and coast.

"We are documenting the [wastewater / solid-waste] burden at [location] and its threat to the aquifer and the coast. We ask your help in developing the wastewater treatment and solid-waste management that would protect the shared water and the sea. [Attach evidence.]"

8F — To an international or scientific body.

Subject: Request for support — water and environment at [location].

"We are working carefully on [the water / aquifer / sanitation / land] situation at [location] and have gathered [the science, documentation, assessments]. We ask for your [technical / funding / assessment / cross-border] support, and we are ready to work as partners, factually and neutrally. [Contact and evidence summary.]"

8G — Media / documentation pitch.

Subject: A water and sanitation story at [location].

"At [location], [the aquifer is over-drawn and salinated / the water is undrinkable / the sanitation infrastructure is damaged], with real consequences for people's health. This is a water and environmental story we can document with science, photographs, and — carefully — human testimony. We can provide accurate material and keep the focus on the water and the need. [Contact.]"

8H — Rallying the community (carefully).

Subject: Protecting our water and land at [location].

"Our scarce and shared water, and our land and groves, are under strain, and in Gaza the water and sanitation situation is grave. Working carefully and through the institutions, the humanitarian and scientific bodies, and the cross-border partners, we can help steward the water, ease the need, and safeguard the land. Please help: share what you know — carefully — and stand with us. [Contact.]"

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

If you must move fast and lean, do these six things, in order:

1. **Pin down what's at stake and who holds it.** Which water, aquifer, land, or sanitation — and which body reaches it (EQA, PWA, the WASH Cluster and UN agencies, the scientists, EcoPeace).
2. **Gather the record.** Pull EQA's and the PWA's data and the published assessments and science (environment.ps, pwa.ps, OCHA's humanitarian data); request anything missing (8A).
3. **Document the ground truth, with dates and care.** The water quality, the contamination, the damaged infrastructure, the land — protecting people, never exposing anyone.
4. **Get the matter to the right body.** The aquifer case to the PWA and scientists (8B); the Gaza emergency to the WASH Cluster and UN agencies (8C); assessment concerns to EQA in writing.
5. **Bring in the science and the money.** The universities and ARIJ for evidence; the World Bank and donors for funding.
6. **Engage the cross-border cooperation.** For a shared aquifer, reach EcoPeace Middle East and the regional water bodies (8F).

Even lean, these six create a record, put it before the body that can act, and bring in the science and the help — the ground everything else builds on.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here the field is tilted not by any one actor but by the sheer weight of a constrained, conflict-affected setting: water access that is limited and shared across borders; a scarce, shared resource that can't be stewarded without cooperation; an acute crisis in Gaza; and the necessity, given all that, of working through institutions and humanitarian channels rather than open campaigning. Name these plainly and neutrally as the factual constraints they are — pretending they're small would be false — and then work with them rather than against them.

Meet constraint with the institutional and international levers. Lean on the Palestinian institutions for what's in reach; on the UN, humanitarian, and international bodies for funding, capacity, and response, especially in Gaza; on the scientists, whose evidence on the aquifers is authoritative; on the cross-border cooperation a shared resource requires; and on humanitarian access and aid for the crisis. Meet the constraints not with confrontation but with science, institutions, humanitarian response, and cooperation, built up patiently over time.

And be honest about falling short. You may achieve less than you seek against so hard a setting — the water may stay scarce, the aquifer strained, the crisis acute, the cooperation slow. This guide won't pretend

otherwise. But the work is rarely wholly wasted: a harm documented, a water safeguard won, a sanitation repair made, an aquifer better protected, land safeguarded, humanitarian help brought — each is a genuine good, above all where it eases suffering and protects health. Press on carefully and humanely; each safeguard and each measure of help is real and lasting.

WHEN IT'S ABOUT MAKING SURE HELP REACHES THE NEED

In most guides this chapter is about corruption. Here, given how much of the work depends on aid, the honest counterpart is broader and less about any one actor's wrongdoing: it's the challenge, common to every aid-dependent and crisis setting, of making sure the funds, materials, and aid meant for water, sanitation, and the environment actually reach the need — efficiently, transparently, and where it's greatest. The concern is aid effectiveness and the faithful stewardship of scarce resources.

The marks are specific and named neutrally: aid or funds for water and sanitation slow to reach the need; materials for infrastructure repair delayed or lacking; resources not reaching the most affected communities; scarce environmental funds not faithfully stewarded.

The response runs through transparency, accountability, and stewardship. Use the assessments and the science to show where the need is greatest. Use the aid and funding records to follow whether help reaches it. Use the donors' and humanitarian bodies' own accountability standards to encourage efficient, faithful delivery. And use the institutions' own mandates to steward the scarce resources well. Document neutrally and constructively, keep it factual and humane, and encourage rather than accuse — because in this setting transparency, accountability, and stewardship are the genuine and neutral avenues for making sure help reaches the water and sanitation need.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE

The steps run in parallel, not in sequence, and all of them stay careful, humane, and strictly neutral. Documentation builds the science-and-impact file; target identification aims it at the right body; the careful coalition organises the institutions, humanitarian bodies, scientists, and cross-border partners; the water/land/sanitation work stewards the water, eases the crisis, and safeguards the land; and factual, humane media carries the water-and-land story. A single documented case is at once a water safeguard, a humanitarian appeal, a scientific study, and a cross-border cooperation. Run together they compound; run one at a time they stall.

Early (weeks 1–8): establish the impact and the science; identify the water, the crisis, the land, and the waste, and which body reaches each; build the careful coalition; and, in acute situations, engage the humanitarian response at once.

Middle (months–years, ongoing for the crisis): steward and protect the aquifers; address the Gaza crisis through the humanitarian and institutional response; safeguard the land and groves; manage the wastewater and waste; pursue the cross-border cooperation.

Later (years): the water stewarded where possible, the crisis eased and harm reduced, the land safeguarded, the waste managed — real, if partial, gains in a hard setting.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Caring for the environment in Palestine is genuinely possible, though in a deeply constrained and conflict-affected setting that demands the utmost care, humanity, and strict neutrality on everything political. The constraints are real and this guide has named them from its first line: water access limited and shared, a scarce resource that needs cooperation, an acute crisis in Gaza, and much of the work necessarily institutional and international. And the levers are just as real: the aquifers can be stewarded and protected; the Gaza water and sanitation crisis can be eased through the humanitarian and institutional response; the land and olive groves can be safeguarded; the wastewater and waste can be managed; and the Palestinian institutions, the UN and humanitarian bodies, the scientists, and the cross-border cooperation genuinely work.

Here's the discipline that gives the work its force: document the impact and the science; take the aquifer case to the PWA and the scientists, and environmental harm to EQA; take the Gaza emergency to the WASH Cluster and the UN agencies; safeguard the land and groves through the institutions and municipalities; build the wastewater and waste management that protects the water and sea; bring in the World Bank and donors for funding and EcoPeace for the cross-border cooperation; keep humane attention to Gaza; protect people and never expose anyone; and hold strict neutrality on all political matters. The water is the heart of it — a scarce, shared, gravely strained resource. Gaza's crisis is acute — a humanitarian emergency to be met humanely. And the land and groves are cherished — a livelihood and heritage to safeguard. The water and land of Palestine are worth every careful, science-grounded, humane effort — and stewarding the water, easing the crisis, safeguarding the land, and managing the waste, so a land of acute scarcity may have cleaner water, better sanitation, and safer land, and so suffering may be eased, is work the Palestinian institutions, the international and humanitarian bodies, the scientists, and the cross-border partners can genuinely do. So can you.